

Erdem Bıyık

<https://ebiyik.github.io>

<https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=P-G3sjYAAAAJa>

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Room 305C, Los Angeles, CA 90089

CURRENT POSITION

University of Southern California

- Assistant Professor of Computer Science

Assistant Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering - Systems (by courtesy)

Los Angeles, CA, USA

Aug 2023 – present

Jan 2024 – present

EDUCATION

Stanford University

- Doctor of Philosophy in Electrical Engineering; GPA: 4.07/4.00

Advisor: Prof. Dorsa Sadigh

Stanford, CA, USA

Sep 2017 – Jun 2022

Stanford University

- Master of Science in Electrical Engineering; GPA: 4.08/4.00

Stanford, CA, USA

Sep 2017 – Apr 2019

Bilkent University

- Bachelor of Science in Electrical and Electronics Engineering; GPA: 4.00/4.00

Rank: 1/170 based on GPA

Ankara, Türkiye

Aug 2012 – Jun 2017

National University of Singapore

- Exchange Student in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Singapore

Aug 2015 – Dec 2015

WORK EXPERIENCE

UC Berkeley, Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI)

Berkeley, CA, USA

- Postdoctoral Researcher

Jul 2022 - Jul 2023

- **Reward Learning:** Working on various active reward learning projects for robotics with Prof. Stuart Russell and Prof. Anca Dragan
- **Reinforcement Learning for Deep Brain Stimulation:** Working on the applications of reinforcement learning algorithms for deep brain stimulation under the supervision of Prof. Anca Dragan

Google Research

Mountain View, CA, USA

- Research Intern

Jun 2021 - Sep 2021

- **Recommender Systems:** Working on active preference elicitation for recommender systems under the supervision of Dr. Yinlam Chow, Dr. Mohammad Ghavamzadeh, and Prof. Craig Boutilier
- **Preference-based Reinforcement Learning:** Working on relaxing initial state assumptions in preference-based reinforcement learning under the supervision of Dr. Yinlam Chow and Dr. Mohammad Ghavamzadeh

National Magnetic Resonance Research Center (UMRAM)

Ankara, Türkiye

- Undergraduate Researcher & Research Intern

Apr 2016 - Sep 2017

- **csMRI:** Developing compressed sensing methods for accelerated MRI under the supervision of Prof. Tolga Çukur
- **SSFP Imaging:** Developing coil compression methods and artifact suppression techniques for balanced SSFP under the supervision of Prof. Tolga Çukur

ASELSAN

Ankara, Türkiye

- Intern (2015), Research Engineer (2017)

Jun 2015 - Jul 2015, Apr 2017 - Aug 2017

- **Military Communications (2015):** Developing a C++ program to decode and encode data in MIL-STD-3014 protocol with an easy-to-use interface
- **Algorithms Design (2015):** Designing algorithms to solve composite launch acceptability region problem

- **SSFP Imaging (2017)**: R&D projects related to field inhomogeneity, banding profile estimation, coil compression and banding suppression in bSSFP MRI under the supervision of Dr. Aykut Koç

- **École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)** Lausanne, Switzerland
Research Intern via Summer@EPFL Program *Jun 2016 - Sep 2016*
 - **Approximate Message Passing**: Research about approximate message passing algorithms as an intern in the Information Processing Group under the supervision of Prof. Rüdiger Urbanke
- **Anadolu Agency** Ankara, Türkiye
Intern *Jun 2014 - Jul 2014*
 - **Image Processing**: Developing a Java, C++ and MySQL based program that uses image registration, matching and comparison techniques to detect copyright infringements

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **University of Southern California** Los Angeles, CA
Instructor *Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024*
 - **CSCI445L Introduction to Robotics (Spring 2024)**: Teaching the course
 - **CSCI699 Robot Learning (Fall 2023, Fall 2024)**: Designing and teaching the course
- **Stanford University** Stanford, CA
Teaching Assistant *Winter 2020, Winter 2021*
 - **CS237B / EE260B / AA174B / AA274B Principles of Robot Autonomy II**: Holding office hours and sections, preparing and grading homeworks and exams
Awarded “outstanding course assistant” by the CS department (top 5%) in Winter 2021
- **Bilkent University** Ankara, Türkiye
Teaching Assistant *Spring 2014, Fall 2016*
 - **CS114 Introduction to Programming for Engineers (2014)**: Teaching in the weekly tutorials & recitations
 - **EEE211 Analog Electronics (2016)**: Teaching, interviewing and grading students in the laboratory sessions
- **Stanford University** Stanford, CA
Guest Lecturer *Winter 2022, Winter 2025*
 - **CS333 Safe and Interactive Robotics (2022)**: Teaching a lecture on “learning from human preferences”
 - **CS237B / EE260B / AA174B / AA274B Principles of Robot Autonomy II (2025)**: Giving a talk on “Efficient Robot Learning via Interaction with Humans”

MENTORING

- **Current Ph.D. Students**: Anthony Liang (co-advised with Stephen Tu), Pavel Czempin, Yigit Korkmaz, Yutai Zhou, Yimin Tang (co-advised with Sven Koenig), Ayano Hiranaka (co-advised with Daniel Seita), Raida Karim (co-advised with Maja Matarić), Bo-Ruei Huang
- **Current Master’s Students**: Xinhu Li, Dhanush Kumar Varma Penmetsa, Matthew Hong, Yusen Luo, Zhaoyang Li
- **Current Undergraduate Students**: Jaiv Doshi, Urvi Bhuvania, Ashley Lan, Kevin Kim, Arpita Tomar, Yasir White, Qingyang (Bob) Zeng
- **Ph.D. Alumni**
 - Jesse Zhang (2025, co-advised with Jesse Thomason and Joseph Lim). Next: Postdoc at UW.
 - Ayush Jain (2024, co-advised with Joseph Lim). Next: Research Scientist at Meta.
 - Sumedh Sontakke (2024, co-advised with Laurent Itti). Next: Applied Scientist at Amazon Robotics.
- **Master’s Alumni**

- Mihir Kulkarni (2025). Next: Ph.D. Student in Computer Science at UT Dallas.
- Zhaojing Yang (2024). Next: Ph.D. Student in Computer Science at UC San Diego.
- Jiahui Zhang (2024). Next: Ph.D. Student in Computer Science at UT Dallas.
- Thomas Reeves (2024). Next: Ph.D. Student in Computer Science at USC.

• Undergraduate Alumni

- Shreyas Ramanujam (2025, Intern from IIT Madras). Next: Master's Student at Stanford University.
- Eisuke Hirota (2025, Intern from SUNY Binghamton). Next: MIT Lincoln Laboratory.
- Miru Jun (2024). Next: Data Engineer at US Navy.

HONORS & AWARDS

- **RLC 2025 Outstanding Paper Award on Empirical Reinforcement Learning Research:** Awarded for the paper “Mitigating Suboptimality of Deterministic Policy Gradients in Complex Q-functions”
- **Best Paper Award at the “2nd Workshop on Out-of-Distribution Generalization in Robotics: Towards Reliable Learning-Based Autonomy” at RSS 2025:** Awarded to the top paper among ~50 papers. Awarded for the paper “ReWiND: Language-Guided Rewards Teach Robot Policies without New Demonstrations”
- **2024 Outstanding Paper Finalist at TMLR:** Awarded to 5 papers in 2024. Awarded for the paper “Open Problems and Fundamental Limitations of Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback”
- **Stanford CS Outstanding Course Assistant:** Awarded to the top 5% of CAs in the department. Awarded for the “Principles of Robot Autonomy II” course in Winter 2021
- **Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship 2020 North America:** Finalist (as a group of two PhD students)
- **HRI 2020 Honorable Mention in Technical Advances:** Awarded to 3 papers in the Technical Advances track. Awarded for the paper “When Humans Aren’t Optimal: Robots that Collaborate with Risk-Aware Humans”
- **Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship 2019 North America:** Finalist (as a group of two PhD students)
- **Stanford University James D. Plummer Graduate Fellowship (2017-2018):** Full tuition waiver & stipend during the first year of PhD program
- **Bilkent University Electrical and Electronics Engineering Department, Graduation Awards (2017):** Academic Excellence, Research Excellence, Voluntary Professional Activities, Social Awareness and Activities
- **Scholarship of the Turkish Prime Ministry (2012-2017):** Awarded monthly stipend during the BSc program (given to those who rank in first 100 among 1.8 million students in nationwide university entrance exam)
- **Bilkent University Comprehensive Scholarship (2012-2017):** Full tuition waiver & stipend during the BSc program
- **IEEEExtreme Programming Competitions:** 2nd in Türkiye, 78th among all participants, 2015. 1st in Türkiye, 73rd among all participants, 2014. 1st in Türkiye, 100th among all participants, 2013 (All as a group of three students)
- **Turkish Intelligence Foundation (TZV) Marathon:** Ranked twice in top 25 and once 6th, 2012-2014
- **İşbank Golden Youth Award (2012):** Granted for outstanding performance in the nationwide university entrance exam
- **Nationwide University Entrance Exam (LYS):** Ranked 13th among 1.8 million students in Türkiye, 2012

INVITED TALKS & POSTER PRESENTATIONS

- Robot Learning with Minimal Human Feedback
 - Advancing AI Capacity in Indonesian Universities: A Collaborative Workshop for Faculty Members (2025)
 - Stanford University, Guest Lecture at “Principles of Robot Autonomy II” (2025)
 - University of Pennsylvania, General Robotics, Automation, Sensing, & Perception Lab (GRASP) Seminar (2025)
 - UC Santa Barbara, The Center for Control, Dynamical Systems, and Computation Seminar (2025)
 - Bilkent University, Electrical and Electronics Engineering Department, Graduate Seminar (2024)

- University of Washington, Robotics Seminar (2024)
 - University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Human-Centered Autonomy Lab (2024)
- Learning Humans' Tradeoffs between Objectives via Language Feedback
 - RSS 2025 Workshop on Multi-Objective Optimization and Planning in Robotics
- Multi-Agent Inverse Q-Learning from Demonstrations
 - ICRA 2025
- RAILGUN: A Unified Convolutional Policy for Multi-Agent Path Finding Across Different Environments and Tasks
 - ICRA 2025 Workshop on Foundation Models and Neuro-Symbolic AI for Robotics (poster)
- Asking Easy Questions: A User-Friendly Approach to Active Reward Learning
 - Inzva & AI Safety Türkiye, AI Safety Talks (2025)
 - CoRL 2019 (poster)
- Open Problems in Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback and Potential Solutions for Data-Efficiency
 - Caltech AI Alignment Club (2025)
 - University of Amsterdam, The Amsterdam Machine Learning Lab (2023)
- Efficient Robot Learning via Interaction with Humans
 - New Faculty Highlights at the 39th Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence, 2025
 - Southern California Robotics (SCR) Symposium 2023
- Reinforcement Learning from Comparative Language Feedback
 - The Inaugural Conference of the International Association for Safe and Ethical AI (IASEAI 2025 – poster)
- Trajectory Improvement and Reward Learning from Comparative Language Feedback
 - CoRL 2024 (poster)
- Preference Learning from Minimal Human Feedback for Interactive Autonomy
 - ODSC West 2024 Conference (Open Data Science Conference)
 - International Conference on Micro, Nano and Smart Systems (IC-MNSS) 2024
 - IIT Hyderabad, Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering, Department Seminar & Technology Innovation Hub on Autonomous Navigation and Data Acquisition Systems (2024)
- Making Robot Learning More Natural Through Human Saliency and Language
 - RSS 2024 Workshop on “Mechanisms for Mapping Human Input to Robots: From Robot Learning to Shared Control/Autonomy”
- Data- and Time-Efficient Learning of Human Preferences
 - 8th Annual Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI) Workshop (2024)
- Optimizing Robot Behavior via Comparative Language Feedback
 - Human-Interactive Robot Learning (Workshop at HRI 2024 – poster)
- Data-Efficient Learning from Human Feedback and Large Pretrained Models for Robotics
 - Arizona State University, School of Computing and Augmented Intelligence (2023)
- ViSaRL: Visual Reinforcement Learning Guided by Human Saliency
 - 7th Annual Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI) Workshop (2023 – poster)

- Learning Preferences for Interactive Autonomy
 - Middle East Technical University, Robotics and AI Technologies Application and Research Center (2022)
 - Sonoma State University, Engineering Colloquium (2022)
 - Cornell University, Robotics Seminar (2022)
 - University of Wisconsin-Madison, Computer Science, Department Seminar (2022)
 - University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Computer Science, Department Seminar (2022)
 - University of Michigan, Robotics Institute, Department Seminar (2022)
 - University of Southern California, Computer Science, Department Seminar (2022)
 - Imperial College London, Department of Aeronautics, Aerodynamics & Control Seminar (2022)
 - Carnegie Mellon University, Robotics Institute, Department Seminar (2022)
 - UCLA, Electrical and Computer Engineering, Department Seminar (2022)
 - Bilkent University, Electrical and Electronics Engineering, Graduate Seminar (2021)
 - UC Berkeley, Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI), Beneficial AI Seminar (2021)
 - Sabancı University, Computer Science & Engineering, Department Seminar (2021)
 - Koç University, AI Meetings (2021)
 - Bay Area Robotics Symposium (BARS) 2021 (poster)
 - Virginia Tech, Mechanical Engineering, Department Seminar (2021)
 - Caltech Yue Lab (2021)
 - UT Austin, Personal Autonomous Robotics Lab (2021)
 - UC Berkeley, InterACT Lab (2021)
- Learning Multimodal Rewards from Rankings
 - 6th Annual Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI) Workshop (2022)
 - CoRL 2021
- Learning from Humans for Adaptive Interaction
 - HRI Pioneers 2022
- APReL: A Library for Active Preference-based Reward Learning Algorithms
 - Human-Interactive Robot Learning (HIRL) (Workshop at HRI 2022)
 - HRI 2022
 - AI-HRI 2021 at AAAI Fall Symposium Series
- Partner-Aware Algorithms in Decentralized Cooperative Bandit Teams
 - AAAI 2022
 - AI-HRI 2021 at AAAI Fall Symposium Series
- The Role of Representations in Human-Aware Learning and Control (*with Dorsa Sadigh*)
 - “Aware-Learning: How to Benefit from Priors” Workshop @ CDC 2021
- Interactive Robotics through the Lens of Learning (*with Dorsa Sadigh*)
 - NCCR (The National Centre of Competence in Research, Switzerland) Automation Seminar, 2021
- Leveraging Smooth Attention Prior for Multi-Agent Trajectory Prediction
 - Center for Automotive Research at Stanford (CARS) Annual Meeting (2021 – poster)
- Learning Reward Functions from Scale Feedback

- CoRL 2021 (poster)
- Learning how to Dynamically Route Autonomous Vehicles on Shared Roads
 - ETH Zurich, Institute for Dynamic Systems and Control, Autonomy Talks (2021)
 - The 32nd IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium Workshop (2021)
 - 3rd NorCal Control Workshop (2021)
 - Stanford Robotics Lunch (2019)
 - Center for Automotive Research at Stanford (CARS) Annual Meeting (2020 – poster)
- Walking the Boundary of Learning and Interaction (*with Dorsa Sadigh*)
 - 3rd Robot Learning Workshop: Grounding Machine Learning Development in the Real World @ NeurIPS 2020
- When Humans Aren't Optimal: Robots that Collaborate with Risk-Aware Humans (*with Minae Kwon*)
 - University of Chicago, Graduate Seminar on Topics in Human-Robot Interaction (2020)
- Active Preference-Based Gaussian Process Regression for Reward Learning
 - RSS 2020
- The Green Choice: Learning and Influencing Human Decisions on Shared Roads
 - CDC 2019
- Active Learning of Reward Dynamics from Hierarchical Queries
 - IROS 2019
- Efficient and Safe Exploration in Deterministic Markov Decision Processes with Unknown Transition Models
 - ACC 2019
 - Stanford AI Safety Retreat 2019 (poster)
- Batch Active Preference-Based Learning of Reward Functions
 - CoRL 2018
 - Stanford HAI 2019 (poster)
 - TRI Joint University Workshop 2019 (poster)
 - Stanford SystemX Fall 2018 (poster)
 - BARS - Bay Area Robotics Symposium (BARS) 2018 (poster)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Conferences Organized**
 - **Local Arrangements Co-Chair**, Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS), 2025
 - **Organizer**, Human-in-the-Loop Robot Learning: Teaching, Correcting, and Adapting (Workshop at Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS)), 2025
 - **Finance Chair**, Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL), 2024
 - **Local Arrangements Chair**, Bay Area Robotics Symposium (BARS), 2021
 - **Local Arrangements Chair**, Bay Area Robotics Symposium (BARS), 2020
 - **Organizer**, Emergent Behaviors in Human-Robot Systems (Workshop at Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS)), 2020
 - **Local Arrangements Chair**, Bay Area Robotics Symposium (BARS), 2018

- **Program Committee Member**

- ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI), 2025
- The 39th Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence, AI Alignment Track (2025)
- 8th Annual Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI) Workshop, 2024
- 7th Annual Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI) Workshop, 2023

- **Editorial Board**

- **Associate Editor** for Robot Learning, IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L), 2023 – present
- **Associate Editor**, IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2025
- **Area Chair** for Robotics: Science and Systems - Pioneers Workshop 2025
- **Area Chair** for Late Breaking Results at the ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI), 2025
- **Associate Editor**, IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2024
- **Area Chair**, Responsible AI (RAI) (Workshop at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)), 2021

- **Panelist**

- Human Value Learning Panel at the 8th Annual Center for Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence (CHAI) Workshop, 2024

- **Reviewer for Journals**

- ACM Transactions on Autonomous and Adaptive Systems (TAAS)
- ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction (THRI)
- ACM Transactions on Multimedia Computing, Communications, and Applications (TOMM)
- Artificial Intelligence
- Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems
- Autonomous Robots (AURO)
- Cognitive Systems Research
- Frontiers in Robotics and AI
- Nature Communications
- IEEE Control System Letters (L-CSS)
- IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)
- IEEE Robotics and Automation Magazine (RAM)
- IEEE Transactions on Automatic Control (TAC)
- IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering (T-ASE)
- IEEE Transactions on Cognitive and Developmental Systems (TCDS)
- IEEE Transactions on Control Systems Technology (TCST)
- IEEE Transactions on Human-Machine Systems (THMS)
- IEEE Transactions on Intelligent Transportation Systems (T-ITS)
- IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering (TKDE)
- IEEE Transactions on Neural Networks and Learning Systems (TNNLS)
- IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (TPAMI)
- IEEE Transactions on Robotics (T-RO)

- IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man and Cybernetics: Systems (TSMC-S)
- International Journal of Machine Learning and Cybernetics
- Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)
- MDPI Robotics
- Proceedings of the Royal Society A
- The International Journal of Robotics Research (IJRR)

• Reviewer for Conferences

- Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL), 2019–2025
- IEEE Conference on Decision and Control (CDC), 2019–2020, 2023–2025
- Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS), 2020–2021, 2023–2025
- Conference on Uncertainty in Artificial Intelligence (UAI), 2023–2025 (*Top Reviewer Recognition in 2025*)
- International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2025
- International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2025
- International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS), 2025
- Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2023–2024
- IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2020, 2022–2024
- IEEE International Conference on Robot & Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN), 2024
- Learning for Dynamics & Control (L4DC), 2020, 2023–2024
- IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA), 2021–2024
- ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI), 2020–2024
- International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI), 2023
- American Control Conference (ACC), 2019, 2021–2022
- IEEE Conference on Control Technology and Applications (CCTA), 2021
- IEEE-RAS International Conference on Humanoid Robots (Humanoids), 2020
- International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV), 2019
- ACM International Conference on Hybrid Systems: Computation and Control (HSCC), 2019

• Reviewer for Workshops

- 2nd Workshop on Semantic Reasoning and Goal Understanding in Robotics (SemRob) at RSS 2025
- Workshop on User-Aligned Assessment of Adaptive AI Systems (AIA) at IJCAI 2025
- RSS Pioneers Workshop 2023–2025
- HRI Pioneers Workshop 2023–2024
- Interactive Learning with Implicit Human Feedback Workshop (ILHF) at ICML 2023
- AAMAS Workshop on Rebellious and Disobedient AI (RaD-AI), 2022–2023
- CoRL Workshop on Aligning Robot Representations with Humans, 2022
- NeurIPS Workshop on Foundation Models for Decision Making (FMDM), 2022
- NeurIPS Workshop on Progress and Challenges in Building Trustworthy Embodied AI (TEA), 2022
- NeurIPS Workshop on Machine Learning Safety, 2022
- RSS Workshop on Learning from Diverse, Offline Data (L-DOD), 2022
- RSS Workshop on Social Intelligence in Humans and Robots, 2022
- Artificial Intelligence for Human-Robot Interaction Symposium (AI-HRI) at AAAI Fall Symposium Series, 2021
- ICRA Workshop on Social Intelligence in Humans and Robots, 2021
- Bridging AI and Cognitive Science (BAICS) (Workshop at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)), 2020

- **University of Southern California, Computer Science**

- Zhonghao Shi, Qualifying Exam (Jun. 2024), Thesis Proposal (Jun. 2025)
- Bingjie Tang, Thesis Proposal (May 2024), Dissertation Defense (May 2025)
- Kegan Strawn, Qualifying Exam (Oct. 2024), Thesis Proposal (May 2025)
- Bryon Tjanaka, Thesis Proposal (Apr. 2025)
- Shihan Zhao, Qualifying Exam (Apr. 2025)
- Soumyaroop Nandi, Thesis Proposal (Apr. 2025)
- Robby Costales, Qualifying Exam (Sep. 2024), Thesis Proposal (Apr. 2025)
- Grace Zhang, Qualifying Exam (May 2024), Thesis Proposal (Apr. 2025)
- I-Chun Liu, Qualifying Exam (Mar. 2025)
- Anand Balakrishnan, Thesis Proposal (Dec. 2024)
- Sophie Hsu, Qualifying Exam (Dec. 2024)
- Kiran Lekkala, Dissertation Defense (Nov. 2024)
- Xin Zhu, Thesis Proposal (Jun. 2024)
- Sheryl Paul, Qualifying Exam (May 2024)
- Yang Chen, Qualifying Exam (Mar. 2024)
- Weizhe Chen, Qualifying Exam (Mar. 2024)
- Varun Sreedhara Bhatt, Qualifying Exam (Feb. 2024)
- Jeremy Morgan, Qualifying Exam (Nov. 2023)

- **University of Southern California, Electrical and Computer Engineering**

- Mingye Li, Qualifying Exam (Jan. 2025), Dissertation Defense (Aug. 2025)
- Javier Borquez, Dissertation Defense (Jun. 2025)
- Yuning Zhang, Qualifying Exam (May 2025)
- Zeming Cheng, Qualifying Exam (Sep. 2024), Dissertation Defense (Apr. 2025)
- Mustafa Altay Karamuftuoglu, Qualifying Exam (May 2024), Dissertation Defense (Apr. 2025)

OUTREACH AND MENTORING

- **USC Thomas Lord Department of Computer Science, 2024-present** Los Angeles, CA, USA
 - **Undergraduate Mentoring Program Organizer:** Organizing the program where PhD students mentor undergraduates about their future career, getting involved in CS research, and applying for industry or graduate school
- **USC Robotics and Autonomous Systems Center (RASC), 2024-present** Los Angeles, CA, USA
 - **Faculty Mentor for USC Robotics Seminar (URoS):** Mentoring Ph.D. students in running a biweekly robotics seminar to host students presentations and invited speakers
 - **Faculty Mentor for Robotics and Autonomous Systems Center (RASC) Blog:** Mentoring Ph.D. students in running a blog website about the robotics and autonomous systems research at USC
- **USC Viterbi School of Engineering, K-12 STEM Center, 2025** Los Angeles, CA, USA
 - **Instructor at CS@SC Coding Camps:** Teaching middle school and high school students “how robots learn to imitate humans” in two sessions
- **Berkeley Artificial Intelligence Safety Initiative for Students, 2023-2024** Berkeley, CA, USA
 - **Mentor at Supervised Program for Alignment Research:** Mentoring three undergraduate students on a multi-agent inverse reinforcement learning research project

- **Berkeley Artificial Intelligence Research Lab (BAIR), 2022-2023** Berkeley, CA, USA
 - **BAIR Undergraduate Mentoring Program Mentor:** Mentoring undergraduate students about their future career, getting involved in AI research, and applying for industry or graduate school
- **Stanford University Department of Computer Science, 2020-2022** Stanford, CA, USA
 - **CS Mentorship Program Organizer:** Organizing the CS mentorship program and the related social events
 - **CS Mentorship Program Mentor:** Mentoring first and second-year undergraduate students about their future career, getting involved in research projects, and applying for industry or graduate school
- **Stanford University AI Laboratory (SAIL), 2018-2020** Stanford, CA, USA
 - **AI Mentorship Program Organizer:** Organizing the AI mentorship program and the related social events
 - **AI Mentorship Program Mentor:** Mentoring first and second-year undergraduate students about their future career, getting involved in AI research, and applying for industry or graduate school
 - **Robotics Lunch Organizer (2019-2020):** Organizing bi-weekly robotics lunch sessions where invited professors, postdoctoral researchers and Ph.D. candidates present their research
- **Stanford STEM to SHTM Summer Internship Program, 2019** Stanford, CA, USA
 - **Mentor:** Mentoring high school students in a research project on decision making under risk / time constraints
- **IEEE Bilkent Student Branch, 2012-2017** Ankara, Türkiye
 - **Road to University Volunteer (2013-2017):** Introducing engineering and campus life to high school students from all around Türkiye
 - **Vice Chair (2014-2015):** Managing and organizing the technical trainings and social events
 - **Robotics and Automation Society Member (2012-2015):** Assistantship in the electronics and robotics focused tutorials
 - **Web Team Member (2012-2014) and Webmaster (2013-2014):** Designing and managing the website of IEEE Bilkent SB, its communities and events; teaching in web design tutorials and in MATLAB tutorials; organizing a Java programming competition and weekly brain teasers
- **GazeteBilkent, 2014-2017** Ankara, Türkiye
 - **Online Operations Manager:** Managing the website of GazeteBilkent, an online newspaper
- **Bilkent University, 2014-2017** Ankara, Türkiye
 - **Webmaster of Electrical and Electronics Engineering (2013-2017), Mechanical Engineering (2015-2017), Economics (2016-2017) Departments:** Designing, developing and managing the websites of the departments and developing necessary web tools
 - **1st and 2nd Industrial Design Projects Fairs Student Coordinator and Webmaster (2015, 2016):** Organizing the fair in which the senior students of Bilkent EEE present their industry projects
 - **Graduate Research Conference '15 Student Coordinator (2015):** Organizing the conference series in which graduate students of Bilkent EEE present their research and projects
 - **Graduate Research Conference '14 Webmaster and Organization Team Member (2014):** Organizing the conference series in which graduate students of Bilkent EEE present their research and projects
- **Bilkent Chess Society, 2013-2014** Ankara, Türkiye
 - **Vice Chair:** Organizing tournaments on campus, participating in local events as a team
- **Bilkent Academic Career Club, 2013** Ankara, Türkiye
 - **Physics Olympiads Volunteer:** Organizing a physics competition among high school students

PATENTS

1. Z Cao, **E Bıyık**, WZ Wang, A Raventos, A Gaidon, G Rosman, D Sadigh. “Reinforcement Learning Based Control of Imitative Policies for Autonomous Driving”, US Patent Application No. US17/002,650.

1. E Hirota*, Z Yang*, A Hiranaka, M Jun, J Tien, SJ Russell, A Dragan, **E Bıyık** (*equal contribution). “Active Reward Learning and Iterative Trajectory Improvement from Comparative Language Feedback”, The International Journal of Robotics Research (IJRR), 2025. (*Submitted*)
2. K Lekkala, H Bao, SA Sontakke, **E Bıyık**, L Itti. “Value Explicit Pretraining for Learning Transferable Representations”, IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L), 2025. (*Submitted*)
3. K Baraka, I Idrees, TK Faulkner, **E Bıyık**, S Booth, M Chetouani, DH Grollman, A Saran, E Senft, S Tulli, A Vollmer, A Andriella, H Beierling, T Horter, J Kober, I Sheidlower, ME Taylor, SV Wavereen, X Xiao. “Human-Interactive Robot Learning: Definition, Challenges, and Recommendations”, ACM Transactions on Human Robot Interaction (THRI), 2024. (*Submitted*)
4. **E Bıyık**, N Anari, D Sadigh. “Batch Active Learning of Reward Functions from Human Preferences”, ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction (THRI), 2024; doi:10.1145/3649885.
5. S Casper*, X Davies*, C Shi, TK Gilbert, J Scheurer, J Rando, R Freedman, T Korbak, D Lindner, P Freire, T Wang, S Marks, CR Segerie, M Carroll, A Peng, P Christoffersen, M Damani, S Slocum, U Anwar, A Siththaranjan, M Nadeau, EJ Michaud, J Pfau, D Krashennnikov, X Chen, L Langosco, P Hase, **E Bıyık**, A Dragan, D Krueger, D Sadigh, D Hadfield-Menell (*equal contribution). “Open Problems and Fundamental Limitations of Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback”, Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2023. *Outstanding paper finalist*.
6. **E Bıyık**, N Huynh, MJ Kochenderfer, D Sadigh. “Active Preference-Based Gaussian Process Regression for Reward Learning and Optimization”, The International Journal of Robotics Research (IJRR), 2023; doi: 10.1177/02783649231208729.
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